Animals need food, water, and an appropriate habitat to survive. The habitat usually meets the needs of most animals. However, the habitat cannot meet all their needs. Many animals develop special features that help them build their homes, obtain food, live in safety, and withstand the climate they live in. These special features are known as physical adaptations. These adaptations happen over generations of the species and help the animals survive and reproduce.

Animal Adaptations

Read the information and trace the dotted words.

habitat - place in which an organism can live and grow.

adaptation - a change which allows a species to live in its environment.

species - class of animals with the same characteristics.

valve - fold that controls the flow of fluid.

prey - the animal being hunted for food.

predator - the animal that is hunting other animals for food.

mamma! - a warm-blooded animal that gives live birth.

reptile - a cold-blooded animal that usually lays eggs.

The Bactrian camel is a mammal that lives in mountainous areas and in the Gobi Desert. In this harsh climate, the camel has developed many adaptations to help it survive. These adaptations include its eyes and ears lined with long hair that keep out the blowing sand. The camel can also close its nostrils to keep out the sand. Thick fur and underwool allow the camel to survive cold desert nights and provide insulation against the extreme heat of the day. The long legs of the camel help it travel great distances without exhaustion, and the fat stored in its humps allows the camel to go for days without food. Another adaptation of the camel is metabolizing its food to create water as a byproduct, enabling the animal to drink less water.

Bactrian Camel

Read the information and trace the dotted words.

water	**fat**	**camel**
adaptations	**survive**	**fur**

The Bactrian _____ has special physical features called _____.

These adaptations help the camel to _____ in its habitat. The camel has thick _____ that helps it stay warm at night and cool during the day. The camel's humps store _____, which breaks down into _____ .

This allows the camel to go long periods of time without food or _____.

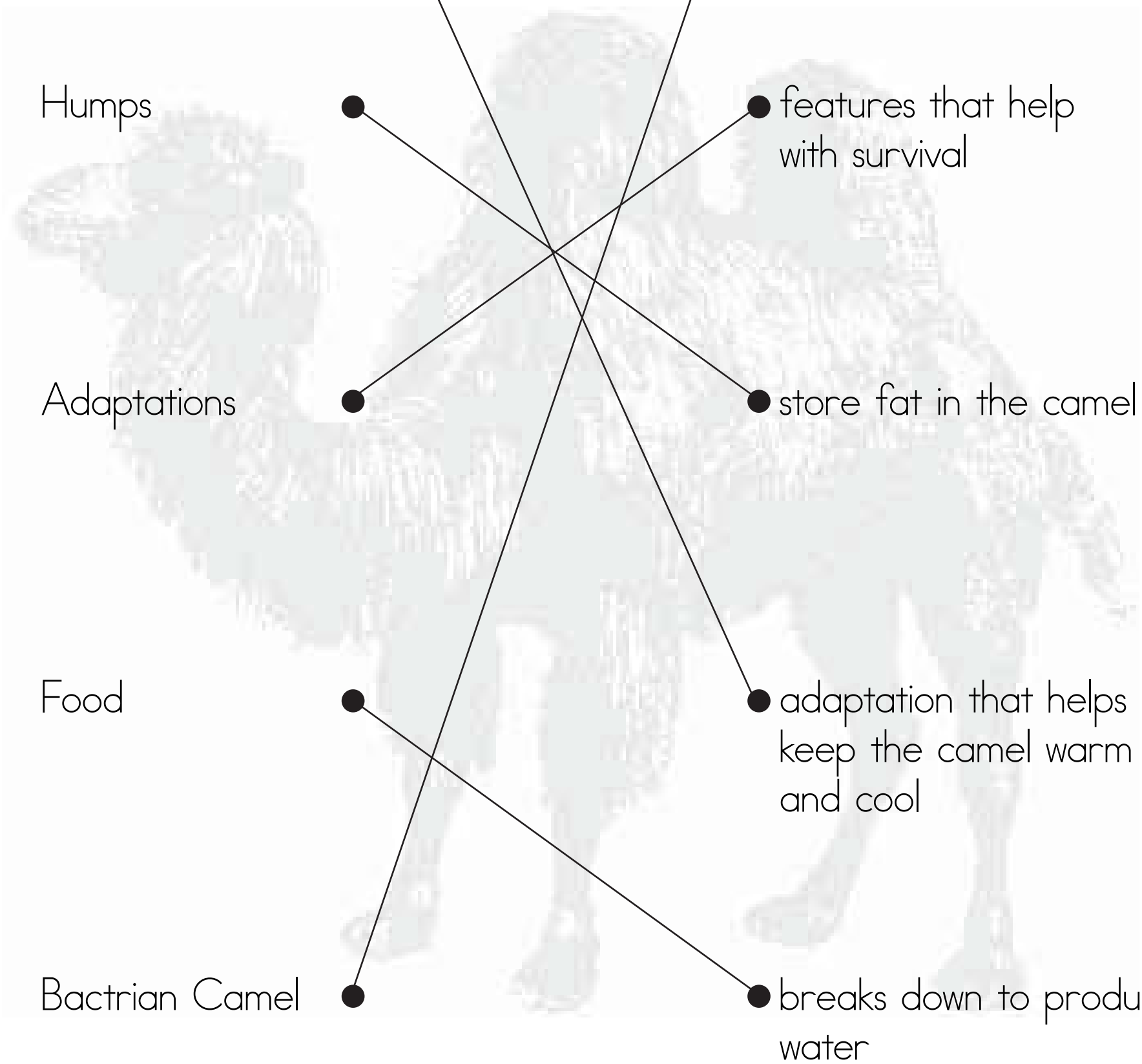
Bactrian Camel

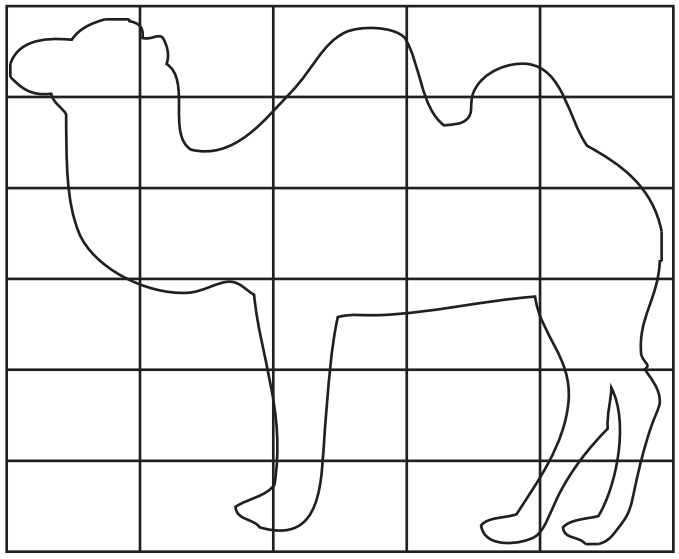
Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

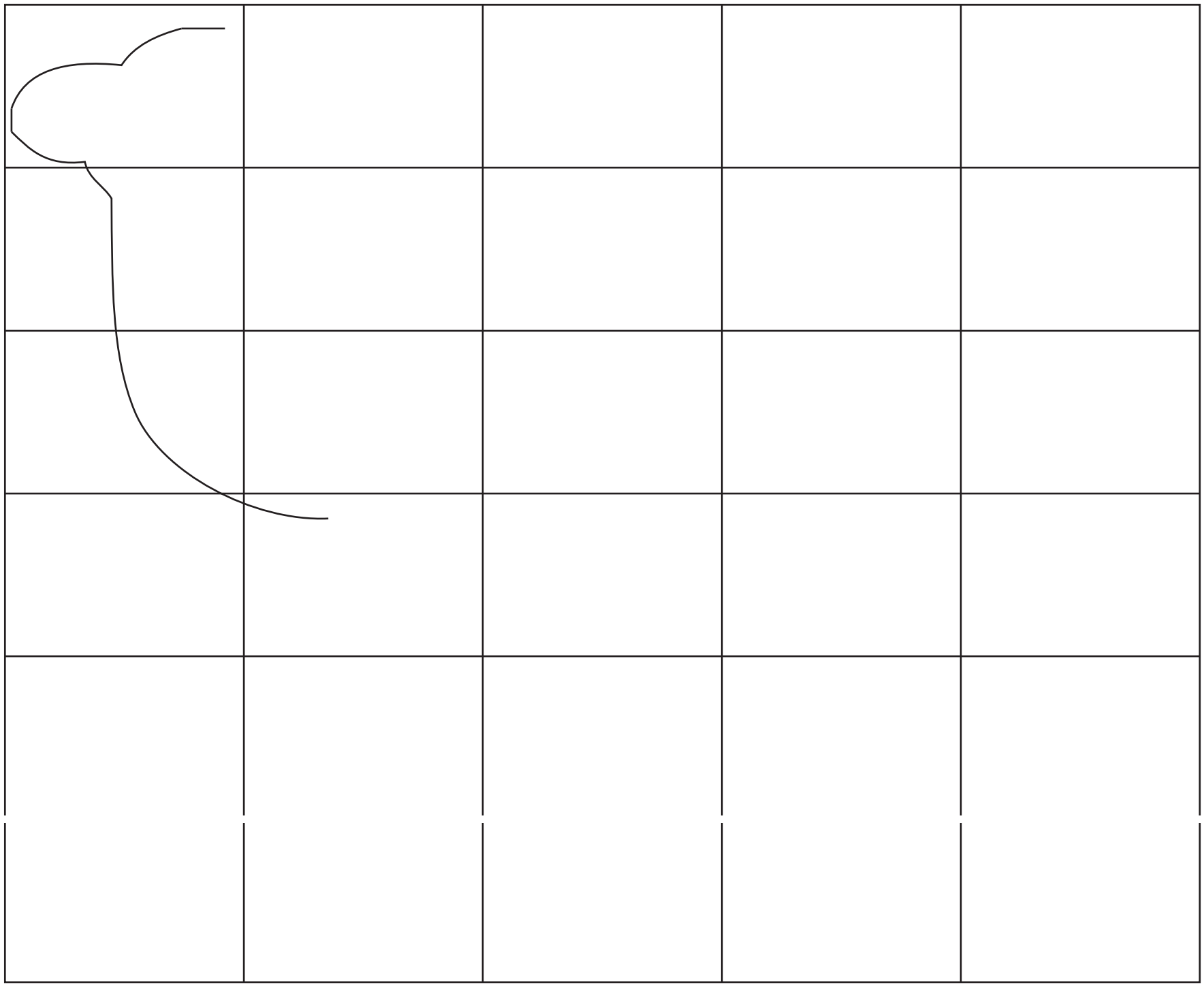
Fur	●	● developed adaptations
Humps	●	● features that help with survival
Adaptations	●	● store fat in the camel
Food	●	● adaptation that helps keep the camel warm and cool
Bactrian Camel	●	● breaks down to produce water

Bactrian Camel

Match the word with the description.


Fur
Humps
Adaptations
Food
Bactrian Camel
developed adaptations
features that help with survival
store fat in the camel
adaptation that helps keep the camel warm and cool
breaks down to produce water





Bactrian Camel

Draw the Bactrian Camel and add the details.

This small reptile has developed many adaptations that help it survive on Round Island in the southwest Indian Ocean. The gecko's camouflage helps it hide from predators. If the gecko is caught, its tail will drop off and wiggle around. This provides a distraction for the gecko to make an escape. The stump of the tail heals, and the gecko grows a new tail. Not only does the gecko have adaptations to trick predators, but it also has sharp teeth that allow it to break through the exoskeleton of its prey. The feet of the gecko are also equipped with thousands of tiny, hooked bristles that help it climb up smooth surfaces or hide on the underside of leaves.

Round Island Day Gecko

Read the information and trace the dotted words.

tail	**gecko**	**adaptations**
teeth	**grow**	**bristles**

The Round Island Day _____ is a gecko with many special

The gecko can make its _____ drop off and wiggle around if threatened. The gecko can then _____ a new tail. The feet of the gecko are covered with tiny, hooked _____ that help it climb smooth surfaces. It also has razor sharp _____ to break through the tough exterior of an insect.

Round Island Day Gecko

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

The Round Island Day Gecko has developed many _____ that help it survive.

eyes adaptations species

The gecko survives on a diet of insects. Its razor-sharp _____ help it crack through the insect's exoskeleton.

teeth nose claws

To help the gecko hide from predators, its body is _____.

scaly wet camouflaged

_____ are an adaption on the gecko's feet that help it climb smooth surfaces.

bristles claws foreigners

The Round Island Day Gecko has developed many _____ that help it survive.

eyes adaptations species

The gecko survives on a diet of insects. Its razor-sharp _____ help it crack through the insect's exoskeleton.

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bristles claws foreigners

D N T G E C K O E O
N O N P G T I R H G
A O O S A A E A A C
L P O F L D A F B G
S T S S F R A E I T
I R E U U T E E T H
D R V I O R S T A I
N S A S M H V A T A
U S E L A C S I E W
O E L R C H E L V D
R E P T I L E A A E

Gecko	Adapt	Tail
Camouflage	Round Island	Teeth
Sharp	Survive	Habitat
Food	Water	Reptile
Scales	Leaves	Feet

Round Island Day Gecko

Complete the Word Search.

Polar Bears are mammals with unique adaptations that help them live in the arctic regions of the world. These bears spend most of the year in the icy waters hunting seals, fish, and other animals. The fur on their bodies is made of hollow hairs that hold air in and helps to insulate them in the cold water. They also perfectly blend in to their icy surroundings with their white coats. This camouflage allows them to stalk their prey. Polar Bears can weigh up to 1000 pounds and have longer legs with big furry feet. These oversized feet help to evenly distribute their weight on the thin ice allowing them to reach the breathing holes made by their prey, the seals.

polar bears	**hollow**	**snow**
ice	**holes**	

_____ are mammals that live in the artic region of the world. The Polar Bear has hair that is _____, which traps the heat from its body. This allows the bear to swim in the icy water. It is also white like the _____. The Polar Bear's large feet help to distribute its weight over the thin _____. Walking on the ice is essential in stalking the seals at their breathing _____.

Polar Bears

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

Where do Polar Bears live?

_____

How does the Polar Bear's hair help it survive?

_____

Why does the Polar Bear have larger feet than most bears?

_____

What is another adaptation of the Polar Bear?

_____

What do Polar Bears Eat?

Where do Polar Bears live?

The arctic regions of the world.

How does the Polar Bear's hair help it survive?

Its hair traps in body heat, allowing it to swim in icy waters.

Why does the Polar Bear have larger feet than most bears?

Their large feet evenly distribute their weight on the ice.

What is another adaptation of the Polar Bear?

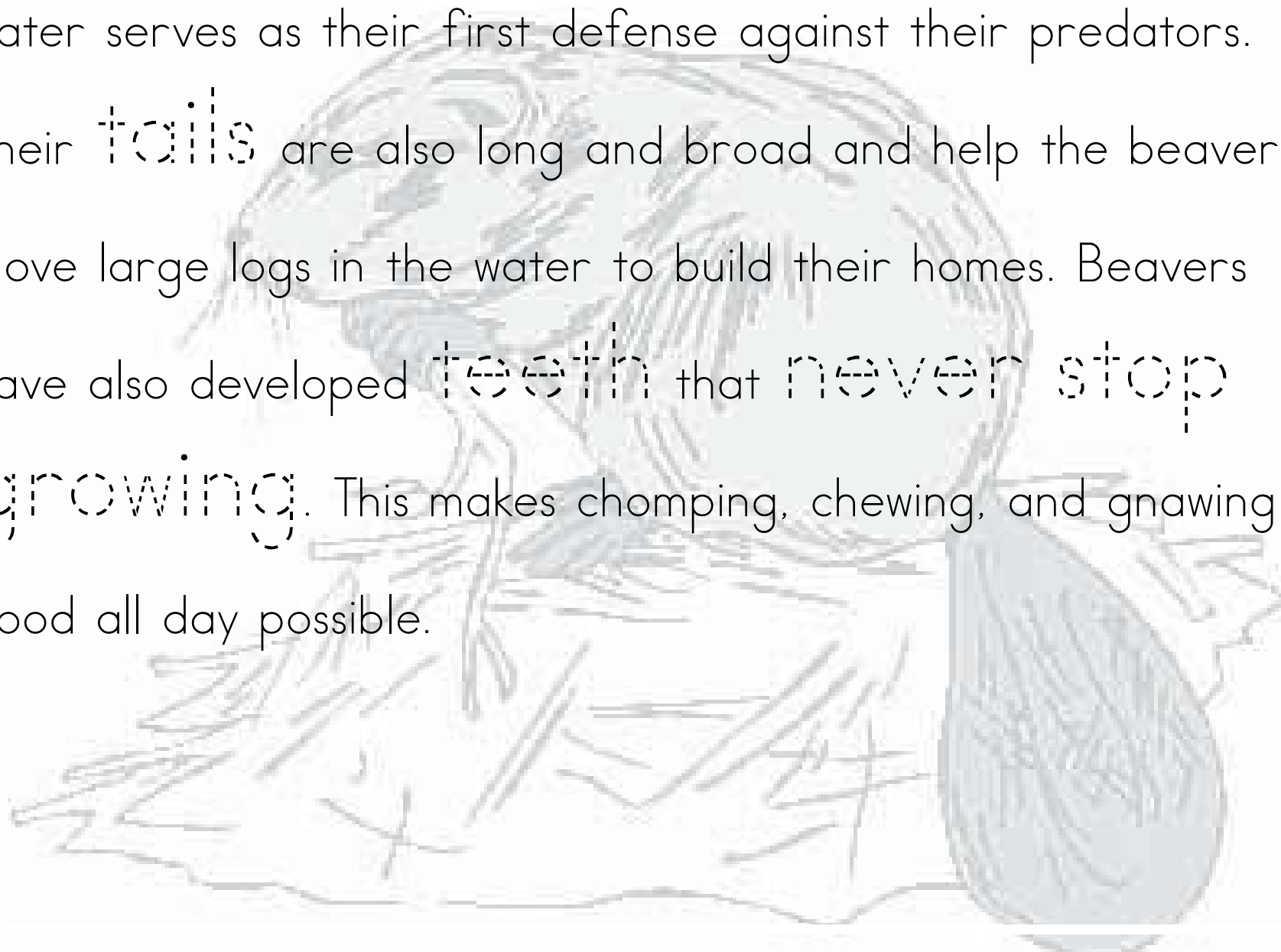
They are camouflaged since they are white.

What do Polar Bears Eat?

They eat meat. Therefore, they are carnivores.

If you could choose to have special adaptations, what would they be? How would you look? Draw yourself with the special traits that would help you survive in whatever habitat you like. Describe your adaptations.

Beavers have large front teeth, or incisors, that stick out from their front lips enabling them to cut wood with their teeth. Their specially shaped mouths allow them to cut wood in the water without getting water in their mouths. Their ears and noses have valves that close when under water. Beavers build dams in ponds. The body of water serves as their first defense against their predators. Their tails are also long and broad and help the beaver move large logs in the water to build their homes. Beavers have also developed teeth that never stop growing. This makes chomping, chewing, and gnawing wood all day possible.



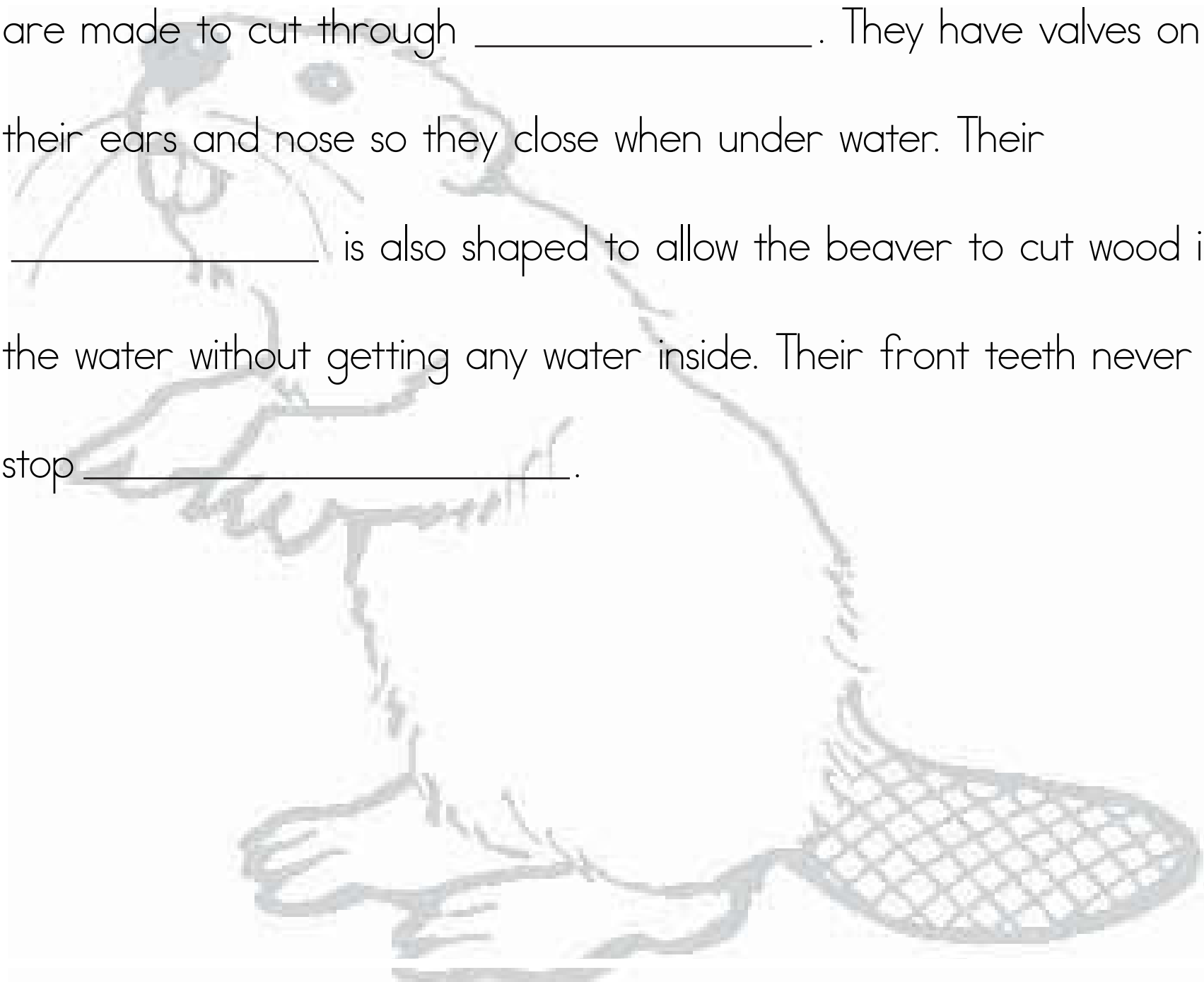
Beavers

Read the information and trace the dotted words.

water	**mouth**	**predators**
homes	**growing**	**wood**

Beavers have bodies made to live in the _____.

They build their_____in the water to protect themselves from _____. The large front teeth of a beaver are made to cut through _____. They have valves on their ears and nose so they close when under water. Their _____ is also shaped to allow the beaver to cut wood in the water without getting any water inside. Their front teeth never stop_____.



Beavers

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

Beavers live in the water.

True False

A beaver's mouth is shaped to allow the beaver to catch birds.

True False

The beaver's teeth never stop growing so it can gnaw wood all day.

True False

Beavers can swim under water because they have no ears.

True False

Beavers have valves in their ears and noses that close under water.

True False

Beavers live in the water.

True False

A beaver's mouth is shaped to allow the beaver to catch birds.

True False

The beaver's teeth never stop growing so it can gnaw wood all day.

True False

Beavers can swim under water because they have no ears.

True False

Beavers have valves in their ears and noses that close under water.

True False

hat	bell	banana
duck	fork	bird
horn	saw	heart
ring	eagle's head	comb

Beavers

Find the hidden objects in the picture below.

The Two-Toed Sloth lives in the rainforests of Central America. They inhabit the thick canopy layer of vegetation and trees. The sloth has adapted to living mainly in the canopy by growing a green algae all over its body that camouflages it amongst the trees. It can also curl into a ball to resemble a termite nest or knot of wood. The sloth rarely comes down from the trees because it lacks any defenses on the ground. However, the sloth can move easily through water due to its fur which allows it to glide through the water. The sloth is at its best among the trees where it can blend in to its surroundings.

water	**rainforest**	**algae**
defense	**canopy**	**curling**

The Two-toed Sloth lives in the _____ of the _____. There its main _____ is camouflage. One of the ways it can camouflage itself is by _____ into a ball like a knot of wood. It is also covered in green _____ which helps it blend into the thick vegetation of the canopy. The sloth does not move well on land, but it can move swiftly through the _____ due to its special fur.

Southern Two-Toed Sloth

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

Where does the sloth live?

Rainforest Ocean Wetlands

Where is the sloth most comfortable?

Trees Land Water

What covers the sloth's body?

Scales Feathers Algae

What is the sloth's main defense?

Poison Strong Legs Camouflage

The sloth's fur allows it to move easily through what?

Sand Dirt Water

Southern Two-Toed Sloth

Circle the correct answer.

Where does the sloth live?

Rainforest Ocean Wetlands

Where is the sloth most comfortable?

Trees Land Water

What covers the sloth's body?

Scales Feathers Algae

What is the sloth's main defense?

Poison Strong Legs Camouflage

The sloth's fur allows it to move easily through what?

Sand Dirt Water

How many different words can you make from the words:

TWO-TOED SLOTH

This aquatic turtle has many adaptations that help it live the majority of its life in the water. It is necessary for this turtle to have a body fit for the water because the Leatherback is very vulnerable on land. Its soft, streamlined shell helps it move easily through the water. The soft shell is also flexible and has a thick layer of oil to keep the turtle warm in the cold depths of the sea. This turtle can grow to a huge size and has a high number of red blood cells. These make it able to stay underwater for long periods of time without surfacing for air. The Leatherback also has scissor-like jaws that are perfect for cutting through the bodies of animals like the jellyfish.

scissors	**shells**	**oxygen**
blood	**oil**	

Leatherback Turtles have soft _____ that are meant to withstand the high pressure of the deep sea.

Their shells are covered in a thck layer of _____ that helps keep their bodies warm.

The Leatherback Turtle also has more red _____ cells, which allow them to store more _____ and surface less often.

The jaws of the turtle are like _____, perfect for cutting through the bodies of animals like jellyfish.

Leatherback Sea Turtle

Use the Word Bank to fill in the blanks.

What adaptation has the Leatherback Turtle developed to cut through soft-bodied prey?

_____

What allows the turtle to stay underwater longer?

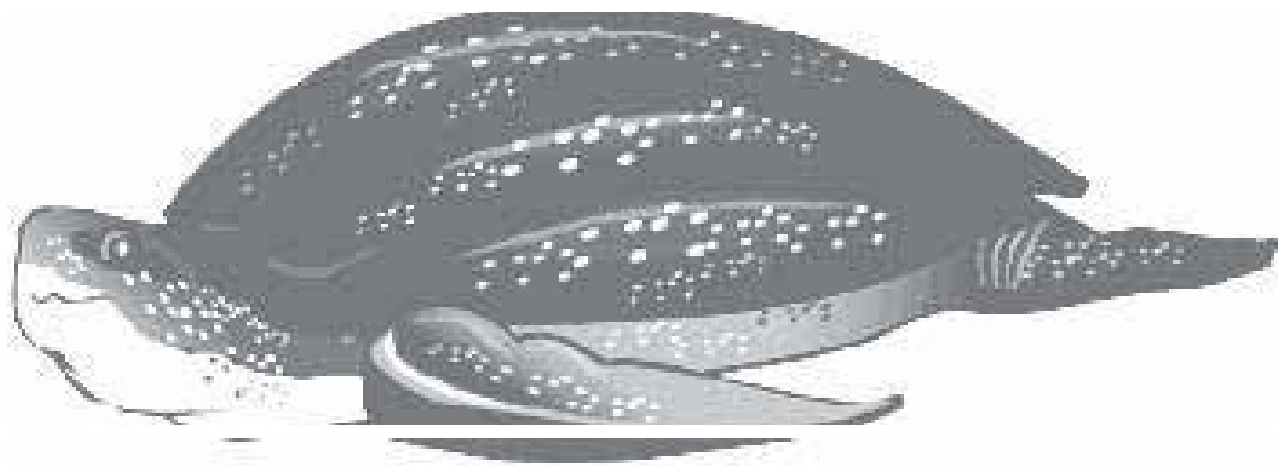
_____

How does the turtle stay warm in the cold depths of the ocean?

_____

Why does the turtle have a soft, flexible shell?

_____



Leatherback Sea Turtle

Answer each question.

What adaptation has the Leatherback Turtle developed to cut through soft-bodied prey?

The turtle has scissor-like jaws.

What allows the turtle to stay underwater longer?

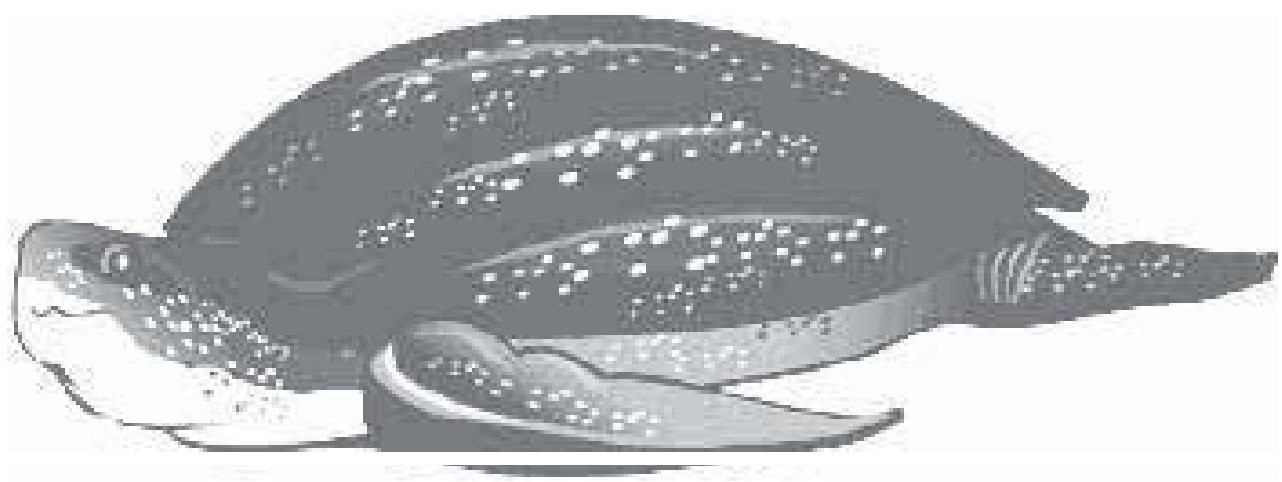
It has a large amount of red blood cells.

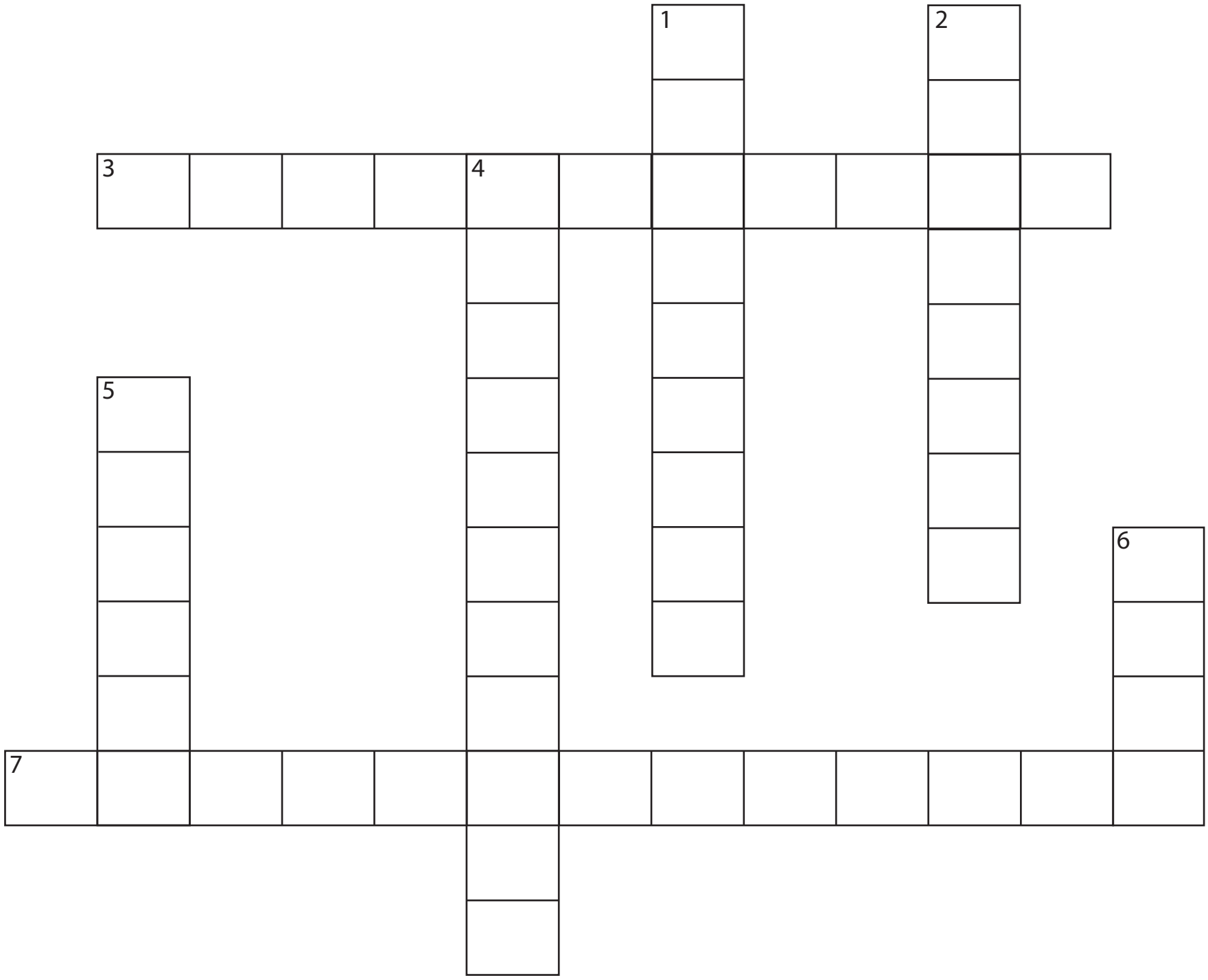
How does the turtle stay warm in the cold depths of the ocean?

It has a layer of oil on its shell.

Why does the turtle have a soft, flexible shell?

To help it move through the water.





Across
3. A _____ shell helps the Leatherback swim.
7. Leatherback turtles have many of these to help them stay underwater for long periods of time.

Down
1. One of the Leatherback's favorite foods.
2. The _____ is high in the ocean's depths.
4. Changes to help the Leatherback live in water.
5. The Leatherback is this type of animal
6. Scissor-like body part

Leatherback Sea Turtle

Complete the crossword puzzle.

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